LEN PEREZ

Lead Product/UX Designer · lenperez@gmail.com · (773) 991-6149 · lenperez.com

I'm a Lead Product/UX leader with 25 years of experience defining, designing, and shipping products across enterprise software, e-commerce, and SaaS platforms. I have a love of distilling complex workflows into intuitive, human-centered solutions. All while bringing cross-functional teams along through clear storytelling and collaborative design practice. I have a proven track record at every stage of the product lifecycle, from early-stage discovery through measurable business outcomes. I'm a Mac enthusiast and also fluent in Spanish.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer / Lead UX Designer · CDK Global *Jun 2017 – Oct 2025*

CDK Global is the leading SaaS provider for automotive dealership management. Over eight years I moved from UX design to Product Design ownership, driving end-to-end design across multiple strategic initiatives. I also mentored junior designers all while building team culture around communication and craft.

AI-Assisted Communication Tool (Lead Product Designer)

- Led the end-to-end UX definition and design of a centralized communication platform for Sales and Call Center departments, consolidating all outbound customer touchpoints — calls, texts, emails — into a single, unified interface.
- Drove integration of an AI component designed to assist dealership staff throughout the car buying process, including suggested responses, follow-up timing, and conversation prompts — a meaningful expansion of the product's value proposition.
- Piloted the experience with a defined cohort of dealership users, using structured feedback loops to iterate on the AI interaction model before broader rollout.
- Partnered closely with Product and Engineering from problem framing through delivery — translating ambiguous requirements into clear design decisions and advocating for the customer experience at each stage of the process.

ML-Powered Service Advisor Tool (Lead Product Designer)

- Collaborated with Engineering to design an application that used machine learning to surface product recommendations for Service Advisors in real time during customer interactions — helping advisors increase attachment rates without disrupting their workflow.
- Navigated the challenge of making ML outputs legible and actionable to non-technical end users, designing interface patterns that surfaced confidence signals and recommendations in plain, jargon-free language.

CRM Redesign (Lead UX Designer)

- Redesigned three of the highest-traffic areas of CDK's CRM used daily by dealership staff: the Customer Detail Page, DeskLog, and Messaging module — consolidating fragmented workflows and reducing cognitive load across all three.
- Conducted heuristic analysis, stakeholder interviews, and workflow mapping to identify friction points before defining the interaction model, ensuring design decisions were grounded in observed behavior rather than assumption.
- Mentored junior designers throughout the engagement, providing structured critique, sharing context on business constraints, and helping them develop their ability to communicate design rationale to non-design stakeholders.
- Facilitated an improv-based storytelling workshop for the design team, building business communication and presentation skills through applied, low-stakes practice — a reflection of a leadership approach that invests in the whole team, not just the work.

Senior UX Designer · W.W. Grainger *2012 – 2014*

Grainger is one of the largest industrial supply distributors in North America. I joined a mature UX practice and contributed to industry-leading digital initiatives across web and mobile.

- Redesigned the selection guide template format for product categories — a UX intervention that generated more than double the conversion rate across affected categories, one of the clearest, most quantified outcomes of my career.
- Designed key segments of the Grainger iPhone and iPad apps, applying existing brand guidelines while incorporating user feedback and research findings to improve find-ability and task completion on mobile.
- Collaborated across a multi-disciplinary team of UX architects, developers, product managers, business analysts, researchers, and copywriters to move initiatives from concept to execution at scale.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Lead Designer / Sr. UI Designer / Sr. Visual Designer *2002 – 2017*

- Purchasing Platform: Led a full redesign of a customer-facing e-commerce site across mobile, tablet, and desktop — from heuristic analysis and competitive benchmarking through persona development, analytics review, and final renderings.
- Press Ganey: Created a Style Guide and Specification Document for their second-generation user dashboard and medical community web software suite. Using the corporate style guide as a starting point, a secondary color palette and grid system were created for the suite of applications.
- Ricoh: Created the Visual/UI Style Guide governing the relaunches of Ricoh-USA.com and MyRicoh.com, establishing design standards across two major brand properties.
- American Family Insurance: Created an application that allowed users to customize and configure insurance plans, navigating a complex domain with a consumer-facing simplicity.
- Medtronic (via Siren Interactive): Designed and built a fully interactive Flash application allowing patients to navigate a new insulin pump's release instructions freely, with an advanced timeline for non-linear exploration.

Web Designer · IBM *2000 – 2001*

- Designed and built websites for both internal and external IBM clients; collaborated with fellow designers on multi-part interactive demonstrations using Flash and HTML.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Core SkillsTools

Design Thinking · UX Research · PrototypingFigma · Axure · Sketch · Miro · Adobe XD
Cross-functional Collaboration · StorytellingIllustrator · Photoshop · InDesign · Affinity
Agile / Lean Processes · Design MentorshipAmplitude · JustInMind · Keynote · PowerPoint
Rapid (AI) Prototyping · Fluent in SpanishPencil & Paper (always)

EDUCATION

BFA in Graphic Design · University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign